DUX OS · SOCIETY ERP

Maintenance Billing Element-wise Help Manual

Elements, account linking, entries and bill generation — step by step

Check before use: rules follow the Maharashtra model bye-laws (13(c), 65–71) and the 2001 Cooperation Department circular. Confirm each rate and method against your society's registered bye-laws and general body resolutions.

CONTENTS

1. Part 1 — The idea
2. Part 2 — Elements: which rule for which element
3. Part 3 — Linking expense ledgers to elements
4. Part 4 — Making the entries
5. Part 5 — Charge heads: setting each one
6. Part 6 — Once: Rules
7. Part 7 — The monthly routine: generate the bills
8. Part 8 — What goes on each flat's bill besides the heads
9. Part 9 — Year end
10. Part 10 — Troubleshooting
11. Part 11 — One-page checklist

Part 1 — The idea

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Vendor bill / voucher → Expense ledger → Element → Charge head → Cycle → Bill per flat
     (Part 4)            (Part 3)        (Part 2)    (Part 5)     (Part 7)
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1. Money spent is booked to an **expense ledger**.
2. Each expense ledger **counts towards one element** (Security, Lift, Water ...).
3. Each element has a **charge head** that says how its cost is shared among flats.
4. A **billing cycle** collects the heads and produces one bill per flat.

If a ledger is not linked to an element, its spend is **never billed** to anyone. Linking is the step people forget.

Part 2 — Elements: which rule for which element

Where: Finance & Maintenance → Maintenance Elements. Open a row to edit.

Keep these as the society standard. Leave **Category**, **Bye-law reference**, **Description** and **Active** as they are, and keep **GST applicable** off unless the society is GST-registered (turnover above ₹20 lakh).

#	Element	Default calculation	Amount to type	Service charge switch
1	Service Charges	Same for every flat	blank	**ON**
2	Property Tax	Per sq ft	blank	off

#	Element	Default calculation	Amount to type	Service charge switch
3	Water Charges	Annual budget, split by area	blank	off
4	Common Electricity	Annual budget, split equally	blank	**ON**
5	Repairs & Maintenance Fund	**% of service charges** (this society)	**0.75** (% of the monthly service charges)	off
6	Sinking Fund	**% of service charges** (this society)	**0.25** (% of the monthly service charges)	off
7	Lift Maintenance	Annual budget, split equally	blank	**ON**
8	Security Services	Annual budget, split equally	blank	**ON**
9	Housekeeping	Annual budget, split equally	blank	**ON**
10	Parking Charges	Per parking slot	per the GB resolution	off
11	Building Insurance	Annual budget, split by area	blank	off
12	Lease Rent / NA Tax	Annual budget, split by area	blank	off
13	Education & Training Fund	Annual budget, split equally	blank	off
14	Amenities / Clubhouse	Same for every flat	only if charged	off

Why each rule

Group	Elements	Reason
Running costs of common services, shared **equally per flat**	1, 4, 7, 8, 9, 13	The bye-laws share service charges equally, whatever the flat's size. Lift: every flat pays, ground floor included.
Levied by area, shared **by built-up area**	2, 3, 11, 12	The authority or insurer assesses these by area.
Funds, a **% of the monthly service charges**	5, 6	This society charges 0.75% and 0.25% of the flat's monthly service-charge lines. (The bye-law default is 0.75% and 0.25% of construction cost a year; use *% of construction cost* if your general body resolved that.)
Fixed by the general body	10, 14	A rate the GB resolves.

The **Service charge** switch matters for one thing only: the non-occupancy charge (up to 10%) on tenant-let flats is a percentage of the service-charge lines. It never lowers anyone's bill.

Part 3 — Linking expense ledgers to elements

Where: Finance & Maintenance → Accounts → Chart of Accounts → open an expense ledger → **Counts towards**.

3.1 Linked by default

A new society, and a society whose data was cleaned, starts with all of these already set — the 14 elements of Part 2 and the links below — without anyone having to open the screens first. They only

need checking, not doing. (A society created before this change keeps whatever links it has; link the missing ones as in the table.)

Ledger	Counts towards
Security Charges (4101), CCTV & Security Systems Maintenance (4109)	Security Services
Housekeeping & Cleaning (4102), Garden Maintenance (4103), Pest Control (4108)	Housekeeping
Lift Maintenance (AMC) (4104)	Lift Maintenance
Electricity Charges, Common Areas (4201), Generator (DG Set) Maintenance (4110)	Common Electricity
Water Charges (4202)	Water Charges
Property Tax (4203)	Property Tax
Insurance Premium (4204)	Building Insurance
Lease Rent / NA Tax (4205)	Lease Rent / NA Tax
Salaries & Wages (4001), Audit Fees (4002), Legal & Professional Fees (4003), Printing & Stationery (4004), Postage, Telephone & Internet (4005), Office & General Expenses (4007), Meeting Expenses (4008), Computer & Software Expenses (4009), Miscellaneous Expenses (4303)	Service Charges

If the wages are of security or housekeeping staff the society employs directly, re-link Salaries & Wages to Security Services or Housekeeping. Link Bank Charges (4006) to Service Charges only if the committee wants it recovered from members.

3.2 Check these

- A society created before the defaults were added may have the ledgers above unlinked. On **Maintenance Elements** tap **Apply standard links**: it links every standard expense ledger that has no link yet to the element in the table above, adds any standard element or ledger that is missing, and **never changes a link already set**. Or open each ledger → **Counts towards** and set it by hand.

3.3 Leave unlinked

Ledger	Why
Repairs & Maintenance — Building, Electrical, Plumbing, General (4105–4107, 4111)	Paid from the Repairs Fund or one-off. Note: **Repairs — Electrical is not the electricity bill.** The monthly bill is 4201.
Interest on Loans (4301), Depreciation (4302)	Not recovered from members.

Link a repairs ledger only if the society recovers it through a monthly head.

3.4 Ledgers you may need to create

There is no standard ledger for the **Education & Training Fund** or **Amenities / Clubhouse** costs. If you incur them, add an expense ledger and link it, or those elements will have no spend.

Part 4 — Making the entries

4.1 Every cost must reach the right ledger

A vendor bill is booked to, in this order:

1. the expense head chosen on the bill, else
2. the work order's expense head (bills against a work order), else
3. the ledger for the vendor's category (set in Vendor Masters).

So always choose the **expense head** on the bill, and make sure each vendor's category is right (a lift vendor must be category Lift). Electricity bills go to **4201**, not to a repairs ledger.

4.2 Where to enter

Cost	Where	Notes
Vendor invoice	Finance & Maintenance → Vendor Bills, or a work order's **Record bill**	Enter every bill with its expense head.
Payment to vendor	Vendor Bills → pay	Record cheque/NEFT and reference.
Cost with no vendor bill (electricity bill, tax)	Accounts → payment voucher	Choose the expense ledger.
Month-by-month standing expenses	Recurring expenses	Shows as due each month; nothing posts until someone confirms it.

4.3 Dates and approval decide what is billed

Only expenses that are **approved** and **dated inside the cycle** (first to last day) count for a head that bills actual expenses. Pending, rejected, cancelled and reversed vouchers are left out.

- By default a payment waits for a second admin or committee member (maker and checker).
- A society whose treasurer is also the admin can turn on **Rules → Who approves payments → Post admin and committee payments without a second approver**.
- Date every bill and voucher in the month it belongs to. A voucher dated after the cycle ends goes to the next cycle.

Part 5 — Charge heads: setting each one

Where: Maintenance Billing → **Charge Heads**. Use **Add from elements** to make a head from an element. Changes apply only to bills generated from then on; bills already generated are never recalculated.

5.1 Three ways a head can bill

Mode	Bills	Use for
Typed amount	The rate someone typed	Funds, parking, amenities
Budget from expenses — Recent average	The last N months (1–36) of spend on the linked ledgers, scaled to a year and turned into a monthly rate	Costs paid **once a year**
Budget from expenses — Actual expenses of each billing cycle	Exactly what was spent in the cycle's dates, to the paisa	Costs paid **monthly**

Why yearly costs use Recent average. In the actual-expense mode a lift AMC paid once a year would land wholly on one month's bills and the other eleven months would carry nothing. The bye-laws have the GB approve an annual budget, levied periodically, and the accounts are kept on the accrual basis — so a yearly cost should be spread over the year. Recent average (12 months) does that.

5.2 Setting for each head

Head	How is it calculated	Mode	Service charge on the head
Service Charges	Same for every flat	**Actual expenses**	**ON**
Common Electricity	Annual budget, split equally	**Actual expenses**	**ON**
Security Services	Annual budget, split equally	**Actual expenses**	**ON**
Housekeeping	Annual budget, split equally	**Actual expenses**	**ON**
Lift Maintenance (AMC paid yearly)	Annual budget, split equally	**Recent average, 12 months**	**ON**
Water Charges	Annual budget, split by area	Actual expenses if billed monthly; Recent average (12) if yearly	off
Property Tax	Per sq ft	Recent average (12) if paid yearly, else typed	off
Building Insurance	Annual budget, split by area	**Recent average, 12 months**	off
Lease Rent / NA Tax	Annual budget, split by area	**Recent average, 12 months**	off
Education & Training Fund	Annual budget, split equally	**Recent average, 12 months**	off
Repairs & Maintenance Fund	**% of service charges**, 0.75	Typed	off
Sinking Fund	**% of service charges**, 0.25	Typed	off
Parking Charges	Per parking slot	Typed	off
Amenities / Clubhouse	Same for every flat	Typed	off

Notes:

- The **Service charge** switch on a head is separate from the one on the element. Set it on both.
- **Amount** is required on every head. On an actual-expense head it is never used for billing (the panel says so); type a rough figure. On a Recent-average head it is used only until the first spend is recorded.
- Only one Budget-from-expenses head is allowed per element (two would bill the same spend twice).
- A new head made from a yearly-budget element starts on actual expenses by itself. Change it to Recent average for the yearly-paid ones.
- **Bill actual expenses** (a button on the Charge Heads tab) lists the heads that can follow spend, with a tick box for each.

- Repairs Fund and Sinking Fund use **% of service charges** with 0.75 and 0.25: each is that percentage of the flat's service-charge lines (the heads with *Service charge* on) on the same bill. Make sure those heads have Service charge ON, or the funds will be ₹0.

5.3 How each mode shares the cost

- **Actual expenses:** the pool is shared **by flat area** for per-sq-ft and area-budget heads, **equally** for fixed and equal-budget heads. A flat billed for part of the cycle carries a proportionate share. Shares are rounded to the paisa so the lines on all bills add up to the pool exactly. If nothing was spent, the head puts no line on any bill.
- **Recent average:** annual = spent × 12 ÷ months covered. Equal head: annual ÷ flats ÷ 12. Area head: annual × flat area ÷ total area ÷ 12.

Part 6 — Once: Rules

Where: Maintenance Billing → **Rules**.

Setting	What to enter
Construction cost per sq ft	Architect-certified, excluding land. Needed only for a head on *% of construction cost*; not needed when the funds are % of service charges.
Non-occupancy %	As the GB resolves, at most 10. Applied to the service-charge lines of tenant-let flats.
Interest % and grace days	Simple interest on arrears, 12% a year by default.
GST	Only if the society is registered. When a flat's monthly GST-able amount is above ₹7,500, 18% applies to all its GST-able lines.
Billing start date	The first date any flat is billed from.
Who approves payments	See 4.3.

Part 7 — The monthly routine: generate the bills

Step	Where	What to do
1	Vendor Bills / vouchers	Enter and pay every cost of the month with its expense head and the right date.
2	Same	Get pending vouchers **approved**.
3	Maintenance Billing → **Cycles**	Create the **New cycle** with its start and end dates.
4	The cycle → **Preview**	Read the **month-end checklist** at the top (below) and the warnings.
5	Preview	Fix what the checklist names. Missing area, unlinked ledgers or pending vouchers each have a one-tap fix.
6	Preview → **Generate**	Bills are made as drafts and the working is saved.
7	The cycle → **Issue All**	Issues the bills to residents.
8	Payments	Record receipts. They settle the oldest bills first.

The month-end checklist in Preview

It says	What it means	Tap
Expenses waiting for approval	These are left out of the bills	**Approve all**
A ledger with spend that no element covers	Nobody would be billed for it	**Link**
An element with spend but no head billing it as actual expenses	The head is missing or on a typed rate	**Add head** or **Switch head**
A head with no spend in the period	Nothing is billed for it	For information

Nothing here blocks **Generate**; it says what to look at first.

Two safeguards

- The same dates of an element cannot be billed twice. A cycle overlapping an earlier cycle's dates (whose bills still stand) is refused. Cancel the earlier bills to free the dates.
- Bills already generated are not changed by later entries. To pick up expenses booked after Generate, use **Regenerate bills** (next section).

Regenerate bills

Use it after fixing the books (approving vouchers, adding a late expense, correcting a charge head).

- It **deletes the unissued bills** of the cycle, and cancelled bills that were never issued, and makes them again from all the approved expenses dated in the cycle as they are now.
- A bill that is **issued, paid or part-paid stays exactly as it is**, with its invoice number. A cancelled bill that was issued stays as a record, and its flat gets a new bill.
- For a head that bills actual expenses, the new bills share only the spend the issued bills did not take. Together the bills still add up to the month's spend. Because late expenses fall on the flats billed again, issue the bills of a cycle together where you can.
- It is refused only when every bill is issued or has a payment. Cancel a bill first to make it again.
- If the new bills cannot be made, the old ones stay.

Part 8 — What goes on each flat's bill besides the heads

- **Non-occupancy:** a let-out flat pays the Rules percentage of its service-charge lines. Owner-occupied and vacant flats don't.
- **Fines and extra charges:** Maintenance Billing → **Fines & Charges**, on one flat, from an effective date.
- **GST:** see Part 6.
- **Interest on arrears:** from each earlier bill's due date plus grace days. Fines and interest are not charged interest.

Part 9 — Year end

Compare what was billed with what was spent, head by head (**Suggest from expenses** on the Charge Heads tab, and **Spend by element** on the Maintenance Elements page). A surplus or shortfall goes into next year's budget as the GB decides.

Part 10 — Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
A head shows ₹0 on every bill	Actual-expense head and nothing approved in the cycle's dates	Approve the vouchers; check the date and the ledger's link
A cost never reaches the bills	Ledger not linked to an element	Chart of Accounts → Counts towards
Charge didn't change after spending more	Head not on Budget from expenses, or bills were already generated	Switch the head; bills are not recalculated
One month has a huge lift or insurance line	A yearly cost on the actual-expense mode	Move the head to Recent average (12 months)
Funds are ₹0, too small or too large	Fund head on the wrong basis, or the service-charge heads do not have Service charge ON	Set the funds to % of service charges, 0.75 and 0.25, and check Service charge on the five service heads
Preview says a flat has no area	Flat area missing	Add the area in the flat master; area-based heads give ₹0 for it
Generate refused: dates overlap	An earlier cycle covers the same dates	Cancel that cycle's bills, or fix the dates
Electricity bill not in Common Electricity	Booked to a repairs ledger	Book to 4201
A payment you entered isn't counted	It is pending approval	Have a second admin or committee member approve it

Part 11 — One-page checklist

Once

- ☐ Rules: construction cost, non-occupancy %, interest, GST if registered.
- ☐ Elements: set as in Part 2.
- ☐ Chart of Accounts: link ledgers as in Part 3.
- ☐ Charge heads: set as in Part 5.2.
- ☐ Vendor Masters: each vendor's category is right.

Every month

- ☐ All bills and payments entered with the right expense head and date.
- ☐ Pending vouchers approved.
- ☐ New cycle → Preview → clear the checklist → Generate → Issue All.
- ☐ Record receipts; review Defaulters.

Every year

- ☐ Compare billed against spent per element; carry the difference into next year's budget.